STUDENT INTERVIEW SUMMARY

Campus-Only Item Exchange App

Interview participants: 2 students | **Target audience:** First-year students

Purpose: To understand students' challenges in buying, selling, exchanging, and donating pre-owned items within the campus.

Interview Overview

I interviewed two first-year students to understand their experiences and challenges with buying and selling second-hand items on campus. Both students highlighted the lack of a reliable, student-focused platform where they could easily find affordable, good-quality pre-owned items.

Key Insights & Findings

- **Difficulty finding affordable books:** Both students mentioned that new students often struggle to find second-hand academic books in good condition at reasonable prices. They currently lack a dedicated platform to connect with seniors or other students who want to sell their books.
- **Lack of a trusted platform:** Students expressed concerns about buying items from unknown people through general online marketplaces. They would prefer a platform exclusively for verified college students.
- **Need for student verification:** Both interviewees considered student verification an essential feature. They believe verification through a college ID or institutional email could help reduce fake accounts, scams, and fraudulent transactions.
- **No dedicated platform to sell or donate items:** Students pointed out that there is no convenient place to sell, exchange, or donate unused items to other genuine students within the campus.
- **Preference for affordable options:** First-year students, especially those who have recently joined college, may be looking for budget-friendly alternatives to purchasing everything new.
- **Convenience of campus-based transactions:** Students would prefer exchanging items within the campus rather than dealing with unknown buyers or sellers outside the institution. This could make transactions more convenient.
- **Importance of item condition and transparency:** Students would like sellers to provide clear pictures, descriptions, and information about an item's condition before making a purchase.
- **Interest in a simple, easy-to-use platform:** A straightforward interface with categories such as books, stationery, electronics, and other student essentials could make it easier to discover relevant listings.

Overall Conclusion

The interviews revealed a potential need for a dedicated campus-based item exchange platform. Students are looking for an affordable, convenient, and trustworthy way to buy, sell, exchange, or donate pre-owned items. The most important requirements identified were **verified student accounts, affordable listings, transparent item conditions, and a convenient campus-based exchange system.**

A student-exclusive marketplace could help reduce unnecessary spending, encourage the reuse of products, and build a more collaborative campus community.

Potential Features to Explore

- **Verified Student Badge:** A badge indicating that the user belongs to the institution.
- **Free/Donate Section:** A dedicated category where students can list items they want to give away for free.

- **Book Exchange Corner:** A separate section for buying, selling, or exchanging academic books.

Research note: Since the interview sample included only two students, these findings should be treated as preliminary insights rather than conclusions about the entire campus. Additional interviews can help validate the proposed needs and features.